

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Chronology, 1707-1761

1707 -> Aurangzeb dies; contested succession opens the core period

1712-13 -> Jahandar falls; Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support

1719 -> Farrukhsiyar deposed; repeated enthronements expose kingmaking

1720 -> Sayyids fall | 1724 -> Nizam establishes Deccan autonomy

1739 -> Nadir Shah defeats the Mughals and sacks Delhi

1748-61 -> Abdali invasions | 14 Jan 1761 -> Third Battle of Panipat.

MUST REMEMBER: Mughal decline was multi-causal: jagirdari stress, succession, war, regional power and fiscal-military change interacted.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Decline as a converging system

POLITICAL -> succession conflict + wizarat competition + noble factions

FISCAL -> jagir scarcity + jama-hasil gap + short-term extraction

AGRARIAN -> zamindar resistance, peasant flight and uneven collection

MILITARY -> Deccan exhaustion, weak contingents and frontier shocks

REGIONAL -> provincial governors convert office into durable autonomy

RULE -> no strand alone explains timing, reach or continuity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Succession and the Sayyid wizarat

BAHADUR SHAH I -> wins the 1707 succession but settles no firm rule

JAHANDAR SHAH -> Zulfiqar Khan's patronage shows wazir-centred leverage

FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 -> throne secured through the Sayyid Brothers

1719 -> the same coalition deposes and kills him

ABDULLAH / HUSSAIN ALI -> office, army and patronage sustain kingmaking

1720 -> rival nobles remove them; factional rule outlives the episode.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Four jagirdari terms

JAMA -> assessed or estimated revenue claim on paper

HASIL -> revenue actually realised after control, harvest and collection

PAIBAQI -> reserve pool available for assignment

BE-JAGIRI -> shortage of sufficiently productive and usable jagirs

MEASUREMENT -> a high jama can conceal a weak hasil

TRAP -> jagir is a transferable revenue assignment, not private ownership.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The jagirdari feedback loop

MORE CLAIMANTS / WEAK PAIBAQI -> pressure for productive assignments
SHORT TENURE / POOR JAGIR -> assignee seeks rapid extraction
LOCAL PRESSURE -> zamindar resistance, evasion, debt, flight or negotiation
LOWER HASIL -> contingent maintenance and imperial service weaken
MILITARY FAILURE / DISTURBANCE -> collection becomes still harder
RESULT -> fiscal, agrarian and political strain reproduces itself.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: The inherited Deccan burden

1686-87 ANNEXATIONS -> more territory, forts, elites and paper revenue

1687-1707 WAR -> siege, transport, garrison and remount costs accumulate

BUFFER REMOVAL -> direct conflict with dispersed Maratha networks expands

DISTURBED DISTRICTS -> assessed jama outruns reliable hasil

POST-1707 INHERITANCE -> claimant pressure and military obligations remain

VERDICT -> Deccan war is a legacy mechanism, not the whole decline story.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: From centre to region: a spectrum

DIRECT CENTRE -> appointment, revenue order and military command from Delhi

NEGOTIATED PROVINCE -> governor and local elites bargain within imperial forms

DE FACTO AUTONOMY -> provincial ruler controls revenue, army and succession

FORMAL DEFERENCE -> title, coin, khutba or confirmation may still invoke emperor

LOCAL POWER -> zamindars and chiefs can cooperate, resist or become state-builders

TRAP -> autonomy is a process; it is not one simultaneous declaration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad compared

BENGAL -> Murshid Quli Khan stabilises revenue and limits jagir disruption

AWADH -> Saadat Khan builds through accommodation with zamindars and taluqdars

HYDERABAD -> Nizam-ul-Mulk converts subedari and military power after 1724

SHARED -> revenue, army and patronage become regionally controlled

SHARED -> Mughal titles and symbolic legitimacy often remain useful

DIFFERENCE -> fiscal settlement, local alliance and military conversion vary.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Jats, Sikhs and Marathas: bounded snapshot

JATS -> agrarian-zamindari power consolidates around Bharatpur

SIKHS -> Khalsa, misls and armed community formation reshape Punjab politics

MARATHAS -> chauth claims and confederate expansion reach Malwa and the north

COMMON -> imperial weakening opens space, but each route has distinct institutions

BOUNDARY -> Shivaji's state detail belongs to Topic 23

BOUNDARY -> later confederacy and Company wars require their proper owners.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Nadir Shah, Abdali and Panipat

NADIR SHAH 1739 -> Karnal defeat exposes weakness; Delhi loses treasure

EFFECT -> severe fiscal and prestige shock accelerates an older crisis

ABDALI 1748-61 -> repeated invasions keep the northwest under pressure

PANIPAT 1761 -> Abdali coalition defeats Sadashivrao Bhau's Maratha force

LIMIT -> Panipat checks northern expansion but does not end Maratha power

TRAP -> neither 1739 nor 1761 alone makes later British rule inevitable.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal were successor states that adapted Mughal institutions, not mere evidence of anarchy.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Regional economic and cultural continuity

POLITICAL CENTRE CONTRACTS -> patronage and resources shift regionally

BANKERS / CREDIT -> houses such as Jagat Seth remain influential

TRADE / CRAFT -> routes and production persist unevenly across regions

AWADH / HYDERABAD / BENGAL -> courts support art, literature and architecture

QUALIFY -> warfare, extraction and local losses remain real

VERDICT -> regional reorganisation, not uniform economic-cultural collapse.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Non-inevitability and final answer spine

OPEN -> decline is devolution and converging strain, not instant disappearance
TRACE -> succession -> jagirdari loop -> regional autonomy -> external shocks
COMPARE -> Bengal / Awadh / Hyderabad by distinct mechanism
BALANCE -> political fragmentation with economic-cultural continuity
REJECT -> ruler-only blame, one-cause crisis and automatic colonial succession
CLOSE -> 1707-61 created opportunities; later outcomes remained contingent.